

Protein Oatmeal

Start your day with this quick and satisfying protein oatmeal recipe. Simmering oats in milk creates a rich, creamy base, while protein powder and peanut butter add extra staying power. A topping of banana slices brings natural sweetness to every bite, but feel free to swap them out for your favorite fruit.

By **Amanda Holstein** | Published on January 5, 2026

✔ Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 15 mins

Total Time: 15 mins

Servings: 2

Nutrition Profile:

Mediterranean Diet Sesame-Free High-Calcium Bone Health Weight Loss Healthy Aging Soy-Free Vegetarian High-Protein Egg-Free Gluten-Free Low-Calorie

Ingredients

- 2¾ cups reduced-fat milk
- 1 cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- 1 tablespoon light brown sugar
- 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- 1 tablespoon protein powder
- 1 small banana, thinly sliced (about ½ cup)
- 4 teaspoons smooth natural peanut butter

Directions

Step 1

Combine 2¾ cups milk, 1 cup oats, 1 tablespoon brown sugar, 1 teaspoon cinnamon, 1 teaspoon vanilla and ¼ teaspoon salt in a medium saucepan. Bring to a boil over medium-high heat. Reduce heat to maintain a gentle simmer; cook, stirring occasionally, until the mixture thickens and most of the liquid is absorbed, about 8 minutes. Remove from heat and stir in 1 tablespoon protein powder.

Step 2

Divide the oatmeal evenly between 2 bowls. Top each with half the banana slices and 2 teaspoons peanut butter.

To make ahead

This oatmeal is best enjoyed fresh, but leftovers can be refrigerated in an airtight container for up to 2 days. Reheat with a splash of milk on the stovetop or in the microwave.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I use a different type of oatmeal?



Yes, you can use a different type, but keep in mind that if you're not using old-fashioned oats, the cooking time may vary. Refer to the package instructions for optimal results.

Can I make this dairy-free?



Absolutely! To make a dairy-free version, substitute the milk with unsweetened almond milk, oat milk, coconut milk or soy milk. And select a plant-based protein powder, as many contain milk-derived ingredients.

Can you suggest some toppings?



Of course! Just remember that adding toppings will alter the nutrition analysis. You can top your oatmeal with berries, apple slices or a drizzle of honey for added flavor. Consider adding your favorite granola, as well as nuts and seeds like crushed pecans, walnuts or almonds, or flaxseed and chia seeds. Shaved coconut or chocolate swirls can enhance both the appearance and flavor. You could even add a drizzle of chocolate-hazelnut spread.

What's the best way to store it?



Prepare and cook the recipe as directed, then allow it to cool completely before storing it in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 3 days. Add extra milk when reheating on the stovetop or in the microwave to the desired temperature.

Can I freeze it?



Definitely! Doubling this recipe and freezing some for later is a great time-saver for busy weeks. For longer storage, divide the cooled oatmeal into freezer-safe bags or containers and store in the freezer for up to 3 months. Thaw it overnight in the refrigerator before reheating.

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size about 1 cup** 452 calories; total fat 14g; saturated fat 5g; cholesterol 23mg; sodium 446mg; total carbohydrate 62g; dietary fiber 7g; total sugars 27g; added sugars 6g; protein 22g; vitamin c 5mg; calcium 404mg; iron 2mg; potassium 828mg

Additional reporting by Sarah Pflugrad, Ph.D., RDN, CSCS and Linda Frahm

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